



Security Watch

Outlook and OWA 'From' Header Spoofing

The Problem

April 10, the FrSIRT (French Security Incident Response Team) reported that remote exploitation of an address spoofing vulnerability in some Microsoft e-mail clients,



including Outlook, could allow attackers to social-engineer sensitive information from end users. The flaw exists in the message header parsing engine, and allows an attacker to spoof the 'From' field that is displayed on the user's screen. This is made worse by the fact that when the 'From' field contains multiple comma-separated addresses, Outlook only displays the first address.

The Damages

Say a corporate SMTP server is configured to drop all mail received from the external network claiming to be from an internal address. By exploiting this, an attacker can bypass restrictions and transmit a message that appears to come from an internal user. A user is therefore more likely to give out sensitive information.

Precautions

Microsoft has reviewed the issue and has said that while a bug fix may be implemented in a future service pack, a patch will not be released for this issue.

Examine the full mail headers of any suspicious e-mail messages prior to taking described actions or following live links.

Windows have to first validate their copy of the operating system as legitimate. The first add-on to be affected will be the Vietnamese language interface pack.

Over five million users have taken part in testing the piracy lock, dubbed 'Windows Genuine Advantage', on its Download Center Web site since September, according to Microsoft. Currently, Download Center visitors using Norwegian, Czech, and Simplified Chinese versions of Windows have to validate their copy of Windows.

SATA II INTERFACE, TOO

First 500 GB Hard Drive Released

Hitachi's new Deskstar H7K500 is the first desktop hard drive to reach 500 GB, and one of the first to use the new super-fast SATA II interface.

Hitachi's 500 GB drive will be available in two versions: a \$500 drive featuring the parallel ATA interface and an 8 MB data buffer, and a \$520 model with a 16MB buffer that uses the 3 Gbps Serial ATA II interface, backward-compatible with the 1.5 Gbps SATA interface. According to Hitachi estimates, the five-platter drives will be able to store up to 56 hours of HDTV, depending on compression rates.

JAVASCRIPT VULNERABILITY

Et tu, Firefox?

Security firm Secunia discovered a flaw in Firefox, the popular open-source browser.

Firefox versions 1.0.1 and 1.0.2 contain the vulnerability, which stems from an error in the JavaScript engine that can expose arbitrary amounts of heap memory after the end of a JavaScript string. An exploit may disclose sensitive information in the memory, according to Secunia.

The flaw can also expose sensitive information from Web sites users have visited, and the information they enter there. The Mozilla Foundation issued a patch that resolves the issue, and advised people to update their software.

There is another angle to the story. The exposed flaw could be good publicity for open source, and could be seen as an opportunity to show that the system works, according to open source advocates.

The publicity surrounding the JavaScript flaw shows "the open

HOT



Gmail

Google has already doubled the storage limit on Gmail to a whopping 2 GB. Moreover, Google will offer free storage increases as user needs expand, thus creating virtually unlimited storage!

NOT

Hotmail

Hotmail is still stuck at a paltry 250 MB, even as Yahoo! has begun taking it to 1 GB. In fact, you get a miserable 25 MB at sign-up, which, Hotmail states on its sign-up page, will be upgraded within 30 days.



source system is working," said Greg Minchak, director of external affairs and an analyst with the Open Source Industry Alliance.

"Unlike some software companies that sit on vulnerabilities until they



One Silly Question How long can you survive without the Internet?



"Just the six hours I sleep!"

Reeba Joseph, Navi Mumbai



"A couple of hours maybe... the longest I can stay without food."

Archana Subramanian, Chennai



"As long as my cable TV works fine."

Dhivya Ramanujam, Thane



"Not even a minute... the Internet's like the air I breathe."

Rohit Madhavan, Kerala



"As long as I can stay without having a bath."

Jigar Patel, Mumbai